

The Book of Ephesians

By Dn Yonnas · Scripture · Youth & Young Adults

Summary

Ephesians reveals the mystery of the Church — the Body and Bride of Christ. Written from prison, St. Paul shows what God has already done (ch. 1–3), how the Church must live (4–5), and how believers stand in spiritual warfare (6). Salvation is not a private idea but a communal, living reality with Christ as the Head.

Lesson Objectives

- Understand the Church as the living Body and beloved Bride of Christ
- See the structure: identity, then life, then warfare
- Explain grace in the Orthodox understanding — God's life and power that heals and transforms

Key Bible Verses

Ephesians 2:8 — "For by grace you have been saved through faith"

Ephesians 4:1 — "walk worthy of the calling with which you were called"

Ephesians 6:10–11 — "Put on the whole armor of God"

Main Teaching Points

- A body without a head is a corpse — the Church lives only in union with Christ her Head
- The Bride image shows salvation as covenant love, not a legal transaction
- Chapters 1–3: you are adopted, redeemed, and sealed — before any command is given
- Grace does not cancel obedience; it creates and empowers it
- The armor of God is mostly defensive: the call is to stand and endure
- Salvation is new creation and union — a new humanity gathered into Christ

Key Terms

- **Encyclical** — A letter intended to circulate among many churches, not just one congregation.
- **Body of Christ** — The Church as a living organism whose life flows from Christ the Head.
- **Grace** — God's own life and power given to heal and transform — creating obedience, not canceling it.

Discussion & Reflection

- Why is it dangerous to treat faith as purely private and individual?
- What does it mean to 'walk worthy' of a calling you did not earn?
- Which piece of the armor of God do you most need right now, and why?